



Blues Forms — the cheat sheet

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Count along: every essential blues form on one page. Roman numerals work in any key; examples in A.

BASIC 12-BAR · AAB: CALL, CALL AGAIN, ANSWER

A7 I7	A7 I7	A7 I7	A7 I7
D7 IV7	D7 IV7	A7 I7	A7 I7
E7 V7	D7 IV7	A7 I7	E7 V7 turn

Bar 9 is the peak. Bar 12 plays V7 to loop ("turnaround") or I7 to end. Quick change: play IV7 in bar 2.

8-BAR · KEY TO THE HIGHWAY CHANGES

A7 I7	E7 V7	D7 IV7	D7 IV7
A7 I7	E7 V7	A7 D7 I IV	A7 E7 I V

MINOR 12-BAR · THE ■VI-V SLIDE

Am7 i7	Am7 i7	Am7 i7	Am7 i7
Dm7 iv7	Dm7 iv7	Am7 i7	Am7 i7
F7 bVI7	E7 V7	Am7 i7	E7 V7

JAZZ BLUES (IN B-FLAT) · SAME PILLARS, II-V CONNECTIVE TISSUE

Bb7 I7	Eb7 IV7	Bb7 I7	Bb7 I7
Eb7 IV7	Edim7 #IVdim	Bb7 I7	G7 VI7
Cm7 ii7	F7 V7	Bb7 G7 I VI	Cm7 F7 ii V

New parts: the #IV diminished (bar 6), the VI7 (bar 8) and the I–VI–ii–V turnaround.

16-bar blues: double the first phrase (8 bars of I) or repeat the answer. Watermelon Man is one.